GLOSSARY

Glossary

Every musical word in the Handbook, in one line, with the page where it is explained.

a tempo back to the speed before p.79

accelerando (accel.) gradually faster p.79

accent a > over a note: start it more strongly p.76

acciaccatura a tiny note with a slash, crushed in as fast as possible p.85

accidental a sharp, flat or natural written before a note; it lasts until the bar line p.36

Adagio slow, at ease p.79

Alberti bass a broken chord in the left hand: low, high, middle, high (C G E G) p.149

Allegro fast and lively p.79

anacrusis an upbeat: notes before the first full bar p.62

Andante at a walking pace p.79

appoggiatura a tiny note without a slash; it leans, taking half the main note's time p.85

articulation how notes are joined or separated: slurs, staccato, tenuto, accents p.76

augmented triad a triad with 3 + 3 keys between p.110

bar a group of beats between two bar lines p.47

Baroque music of about 1600–1750: Bach, Handel p.156

bass clef the F clef: its two dots hug the line for bass F p.27

beam a thick line joining quavers or semiquavers into a beat p.62

beat the steady pulse you count p.47

binary form two sections, A B p.153

broken chord the notes of a chord played one after another p.139

cadence the last two chords of a phrase: musical punctuation p.136

cantabile in a singing style p.76

chord three or more notes played together p.107

circle of fifths the keys in a circle: go right, one more sharp; go left, one more flat p.102

Classical music of about 1750–1820: Haydn, Mozart p.156

clef the sign at the start of the staff that names one line p.27

coda an ending section; jump to it at "To Coda" p.68

compound time each beat is a dotted note and divides into three (6/8, 9/8, 12/8) p.59

crescendo (cresc.) getting louder, little by little p.73

crotchet a note worth one beat in 4/4 p.50

da capo (D.C.) "from the head": go back to the beginning p.68

dal segno (D.S.) "from the sign": go back to the segno p.68

diminished triad a triad with 2 + 2 keys between p.110

diminuendo (dim.) getting softer, little by little p.73

dolce sweetly p.76

dominant the 5th note of the scale, and the chord built on it (V) p.113

dot adds half the note's value p.53

duplet two notes in the time of three p.62

dynamics the signs for loud and soft: pp p mp mf f ff p.73

enharmonic two names for one key, such as F♯ and G♭ p.36

GLOSSARY · CONTINUED

fermata a pause: hold the note longer than written p.79

Fine "the end": after a D.C. or D.S., stop here p.68

five-finger position one finger on each of five keys in a row p.160

flat (♭) the very next key to the left p.36

form the plan of a whole piece, in letters p.153

forte (f) loud p.73

grand staff treble and bass staves joined by a brace p.27

hairpin a crescendo or diminuendo sign that opens or closes p.73

hemiola two bars of three felt as three bars of two p.65

homophonic a tune with chords underneath p.149

imitation another hand or voice copies the idea p.147

interval the distance between two notes p.39

inversion a chord with a note other than the root at the bottom p.116

key the scale a piece is built on, and its home note p.96

key signature the sharps or flats at the start of every line p.96

Largo very slow and broad p.79

leading note the 7th note of the scale, one key below home p.90

ledger line a short line for a note above or below the staff p.30

legato smoothly joined p.76

major scale tone, tone, semitone, tone, tone, tone, semitone p.90

major triad a triad with 3 + 2 keys between p.110

metronome mark ♩ = 76: 76 beats in a minute p.79

mezzo (m) "half": mp half soft, mf half loud p.73

Middle C the C nearest the middle of the keyboard, on a ledger line between the staves p.22

minim a note worth two crotchets p.50

minor scale the major scale on the same note with 3, 6 and 7 one key lower p.93

minor triad a triad with 2 + 3 keys between p.110

Moderato at a moderate speed p.79

modulation changing key during a piece p.151

monophonic one line alone p.149

mordent the note, its neighbour above (or below), the note p.85

motif a short idea of 2 to 6 notes that comes back p.145

natural (♮) cancels a sharp or flat p.36

octave from one note to the next of the same name: 11 keys between p.42

ornament a small sign for a quick group of notes around the main note p.85

pedal (sustain) the right pedal: notes keep ringing until you lift it p.82

perfect cadence V to I: a full stop p.136

phrase a musical sentence, often 4 bars p.145

pianissimo (pp) very soft p.73

piano (p) soft p.73

plagal cadence IV to I: the "Amen" p.136

polyphonic two or more tunes at once p.149

Presto very fast p.79

progression a trip from chord to chord p.141

pulse the steady beat underneath the music p.47

quaver half a crotchet p.50

rallentando (rall.) gradually slower p.79

GLOSSARY · CONTINUED

relative minor the minor key with the same key signature, a minor 3rd below p.93

repeat sign two dots and a double bar: play the bars again p.68

rest a silence of a set length p.50

ritardando (rit.) gradually slower p.79

Romantic music of about 1820–1900: Chopin, Schumann p.156

rondo A B A C A: the first idea keeps coming back p.153

root the note a chord is built on and named after p.107

rubato time stretched and given back, for expression p.65

scale the notes of a key in order, up or down p.90

semibreve a whole note: four crotchets p.50

semiquaver half a quaver p.50

semitone the very next key: no key between p.22

sequence the same shape repeated higher or lower p.147

seventh chord a triad with one more 3rd on top p.119

sforzando (sfz) one note made suddenly strong p.73

sharp (♯) the very next key to the right p.36

sight-reading playing music at first sight p.164

simple time each beat divides into two (2/4, 3/4, 4/4) p.56

slash chord C/E: the chord, then the bass note p.128

slur a curve over different notes: join them p.76

staccato a dot: short, detached p.76

staff the five lines and four spaces music is written on p.27

subdominant the 4th note of the scale, and the chord built on it (IV) p.113

swing pairs of quavers played long–short p.65

syncopation the stress falls off the beat p.65

tempo the speed of the beat p.47

tenuto a line: hold the note its full length p.76

ternary form A B A: out, away and back p.153

texture how many lines sound at once, and how they fit p.149

theme and variations one tune, changed each time it returns p.153

tie a curve joining two notes of the same pitch: one longer sound p.53

time signature top: how many beats; bottom: which note gets one beat p.56

tone two semitones: one key between p.22

tonic the 1st note of the scale: home p.90

treble clef the G clef: it curls round the line for treble G p.27

triad three notes stacked: play one, skip one, play one p.107

trill the note and its neighbour above, back and forth quickly p.85

triplet three notes in the time of two p.62

turn above, the note, below, the note p.85

twelve-bar blues I I I I · IV IV I I · V IV I I p.141

una corda (u.c.) the left (soft) pedal p.82

upbeat see anacrusis p.62

INDEX

Index

Where each word appears. The first page is where it is explained.

a tempo 79, 80
accelerando (accel.) 79, 80
accent 76
acciaccatura 85
accidental 36, 152
Adagio 79
Alberti bass 140, 149, 156, 157
Allegro 79
anacrusis 62
Andante 79
appoggiatura 85, 86
arpeggio 107, 108
articulation 76
augmented triad 110
bar 47, 48, 50, 52, 54
Baroque 153, 156, 157
bass clef 27, 31
beam 50, 62, 63
beat 47, 48, 50, 52, 53
binary form 153
block chords 149
borrowed chord 133
broken chord 139, 149
C clef 27
cadence 136, 137, 143
cantabile 76, 77
chord 107, 108, 110, 113, 114
circle of fifths 102
Classical 156, 157
clef 27, 28, 31, 32, 45
coda 68, 70
common time 56
compound time 59, 60
crescendo (cresc.) 73, 74, 156
crotchet 50, 52, 54, 56, 57
cut common time 56
da capo (D.C.) 68
dal segno (D.S.) 68
degree names 90
diminished triad 110
diminuendo (dim.) 73, 74
dolce 76, 77
dominant 113
dot 53, 54
duplet 62
dynamics 73, 88
enharmonic 36, 38
fermata 79, 80, 88
Fine 68, 69, 170
first and second time bars 68
five-finger position 160
flat (♭) 36, 37, 38, 45
form 153, 154, 158
forte (f) 73, 74
grand staff 27
hairpin 73, 74
half pedal 82, 83
harmonic minor 93, 94
hemiola 65
homophonic 149, 150
imitation 147
imperfect cadence 136, 137
interrupted cadence 136, 137
interval 39, 40, 45
inversion 116, 117, 128, 131
irregular time 59
key 90, 91, 92, 94, 96
key signature 96, 101, 105, 151
Largo 79
leading note 90, 113
ledger line 27, 28, 30, 32, 45
legato 76, 77
major scale 90, 92, 142
major triad 110
melodic minor 93
metronome 47, 80, 162
metronome mark 47, 79, 80
mezzo (m) 73
Middle C 22, 23, 24, 25, 27
minim 50, 52, 54, 56, 57
minor scale 93
minor triad 110, 111
Moderato 79
modulation 151
monophonic 149
mood words 76, 77
mordent 85, 86
motif 145, 146, 158
natural (♮) 36, 38
octave 23, 28, 42, 45
ornament 85, 86, 88
pedal (sustain) 82, 83, 88
perfect cadence 136, 137
performing 168, 169
phrase 145, 146, 156, 157, 158
phrase mark 76, 77
pianissimo (pp) 73
piano (p) 34, 73, 74, 156, 168
plagal cadence 136
polyphonic 149

INDEX · CONTINUED

power chord 122, 123
practising 162
Presto 79
progression 141
pulse 47, 71
quaver 50, 54, 56, 59, 60
rallentando (rall.) 79, 80
relative minor 93, 96, 97, 151
repeat sign 47, 68, 69
rest 50, 52, 57, 71
ritardando (rit.) 79, 80
Roman numerals 113
Romantic 153, 156, 157
rondo 153, 154
root 107, 111, 116, 117, 120
rubato 65, 66
scale 90, 92, 93, 105
semibreve 50
semiquaver 50, 56, 63, 163
semitone 22, 36, 39, 40
sequence 147, 148
seventh chord 119, 131
sforzando (sfz) 73, 74
sharp (♯) 36, 37, 45
sight-reading 164
simple time 56, 59
slash chord 128, 129
slur 76, 77, 88
sonata form 153, 154
sostenuto 82, 83
staccato 76, 88
staff 27, 28, 31, 32, 33
strophic 153
subdominant 113
sus chord 122, 131
swing 65, 66
syncopation 65
tempo 47
tenuto 76
ternary form 153
texture 149, 150, 158
theme and variations 153
thumb under 160
tie 53, 54
time signature 47, 48, 56, 57, 59
tone 22, 39, 40
tonic 90, 113
treble clef 27
triad 107, 108, 110, 111
trill 85, 86
triplet 62, 63
turn 85, 86, 88
twelve-bar blues 141, 142
two-note slur 76, 77
una corda (u.c.) 82
verse and chorus 153